

and ask for your credit card details so you can reactivate your account, or something of that nature.

A good example of phishing in recent times has been the PayPal phishers. PayPal (now under eBay) is an online transaction system. Phishers have posed as PayPal executives and requested people to disclose vital bank information.

6.2.2 How To Tell Something's Phishy

Though the phishers may seem to have gotten their side of the act sorted out, there are some simple ways by which you can detect when there is phishing afoot. Take the PayPal case for example. A phishing e-mail from PayPal does not come with a personal salutation or greeting. Such e-mails are usually addressed to "Dear User" or "Dear Customer".

Phishers' language also suffers from bad grammar and poor vocabulary. You may often find that some e-mails have lots of spelling mistakes, or are written in terrible English. But even a perfectly well-written e-mail is no guarantee of legitimacy. The PayPal phish also had an IP address in the supplied links, which is a giveaway of the legitimacy of the sender.



The PayPal fraud that Phishers commonly use